

The challenger, audited.

SONOS

*A brand equity audit of Sonos, the premium audio challenger,
conducted in the middle of its hardest year.*

SECTION 01

The Moment

The best product in the room. The worst year in its history.

In May 2024 an app update broke the systems, and the trust, of Sonos's most loyal users. Revenue fell 16%, the holiday season projected another 15% down, and the company stood up extended warranties and a Customer Advisory Board to stop the bleeding. This audit reads the brand at exactly that moment.

SECTION 01 — MARKET ISSUES

Why this audit matters right now.

Three problems, one winter.

01	The app disaster	One update broke playback, volume, and trust. Warranties were extended and a Customer Advisory Board convened.
02	The room is crowding	Bose holds the category while Apple, Amazon, and Google move into premium audio with ecosystems attached.
03	The lifestyle turn	Buyers want integrated homes, not hi-fi components. The positioning already moved: "The Home Sound System" became "Listen Your Way."

SECTION 02 — INDUSTRY OVERVIEW

A \$23 billion room, getting louder.

Home audio has evolved from speakers into ecosystems of connected devices. The premium tier is the growth engine, and for the first time the traditional audio makers are competing directly with big tech.

\$23B

AUDIO EQUIPMENT RETAIL SALES WORLDWIDE

+10%

PREMIUM AUDIO GROWTH, EVERY YEAR

\$3B

BOSE GLOBAL REVENUE, THE CATEGORY LEAD

9.5M

HOMEPODS APPLE SOLD IN 2023 ALONE

SECTION 02 — COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

How the premium audio field actually sorts.

Three names that matter.

01	Bose, the leader	Six decades of recognition, \$3 billion in revenue, and headphones on 12.5% of US consumers.
02	Apple, the contender	The second-generation HomePod won over audio enthusiasts while keeping every ecosystem benefit.
03	Sonos, the challenger	4,000 patents and a whole-home system, fighting for awareness against giants.

SECTION 02 — POINTS OF PARITY & DIFFERENCE

Matching Bose, then leaving it.

POINTS OF PARITY

Premium pricing. A sound-quality obsession. Solid brand recognition. A standing commitment to engineering innovation. The table stakes, fully covered.

POINTS OF DIFFERENCE

4,000 patents in wireless and multi-room audio. Products that improve over time through software. Sound tuned with Grammy-winning producers. A whole-home ecosystem where Bose builds one excellent box at a time.

WHAT IT MEANS

Where Bose sells the power of sound, Sonos sells the craft of it. The differentiation is real. The audience just hasn't heard it yet.

SECTION 03 — BRAND INVENTORY

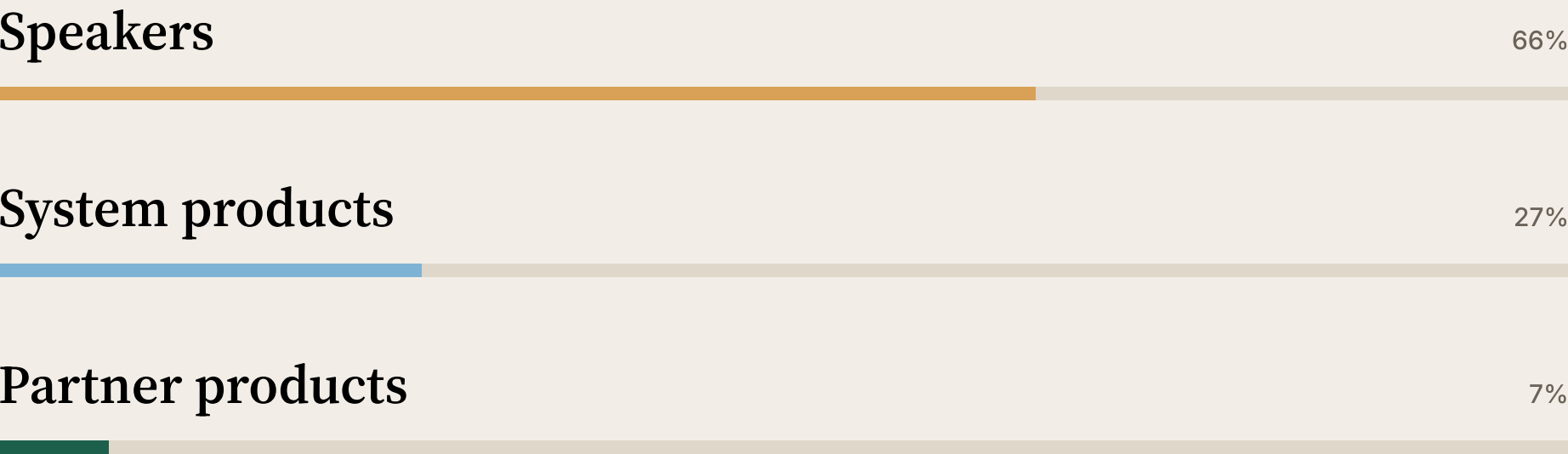
Inside the machine.

Founded in Santa Barbara in 2002, public on NASDAQ since 2018. Flagship products run from the Ace headphones to the Era 300 and Arc Ultra, priced \$179 to \$2,900. More than 85% of revenue still flows through retail partners.

4,000

PATENTS IN WIRELESS AND MULTI-ROOM AUDIO

REVENUE MIX BY SEGMENT



The 2024 refresh moved Sonos from tech company to premium lifestyle brand.

An identity built around lifestyle.

01 — THE AMBIGRAM

A logo that reads the same from any angle. Flexibility and adaptability, drawn as a mark.



02 — THE SEASONAL PALETTE

No single permanent color. Sky, Rose, Sand, Rust, and Pine rotate so the brand never dates.



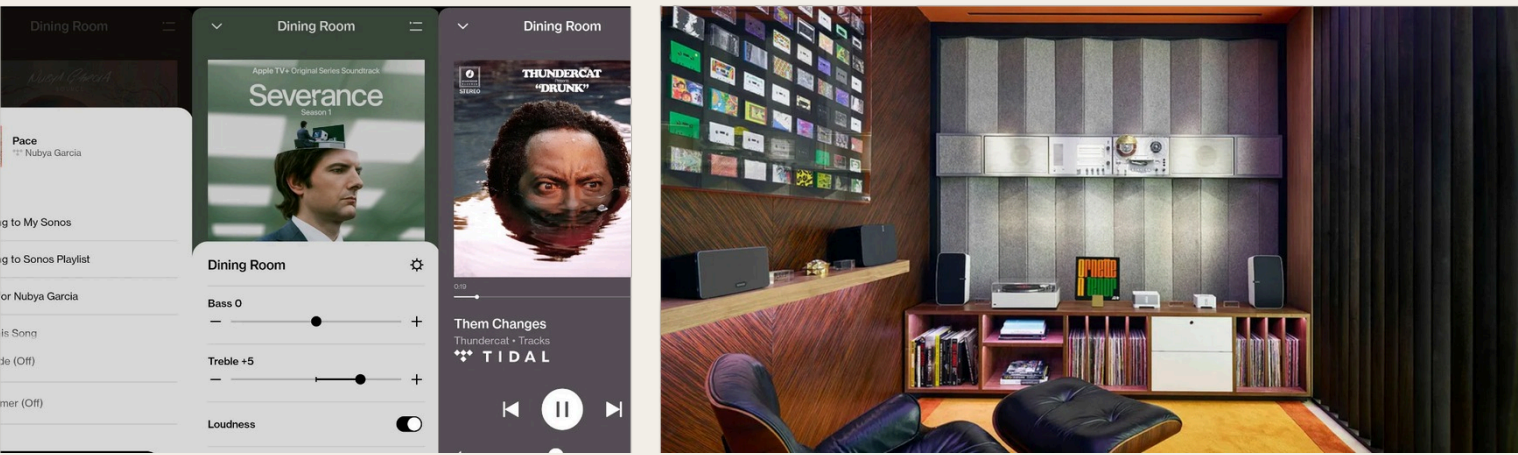
03 — THE TYPOGRAPHY

Helvetica Neue out, Aktiv Grotesk in. More distinctive, still premium.



04 — THE ENVIRONMENT

Upscale, premium, comfortable design language that translates seamlessly from digital to physical



SECTION 03

Positioning Statement

"To affluent urban professionals who value premium audio and the smart home, Sonos is the wireless audio brand whose products work flawlessly together across rooms."

Backed by patented wireless technology, seamless streaming integration, and sound professionally tuned with Grammy-winning producers.

SECTION 04 — BRAND EXPLORATORY / BUYER PROFILES

Who actually buys.

PRIMARY — THE OPTIMIZERS

Affluent urban professionals, 25 to 54, households over \$75K.
Research-driven early adopters who treat technology as personal expression. Skews male, and price-conscious despite the income.

SECONDARY — THE CURATORS

Design-conscious lifestyle consumers, late 20s to mid 30s, evenly split between men and women. They find Sonos through design collaborations and lifestyle channels, not spec sheets or audio forums.

WHAT IT MEANS

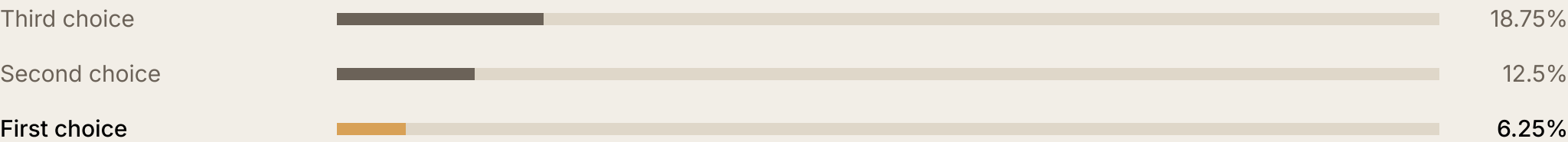
The primary buys the engineering. The secondary buys the aesthetic. The brand has to speak both languages without losing either.

SECTION 04 — PRIMARY RESEARCH / AWARENESS

62.5%

of respondents had never heard of Sonos.

PREFERENCE RANK AMONG THOSE WHO KNOW THE BRAND



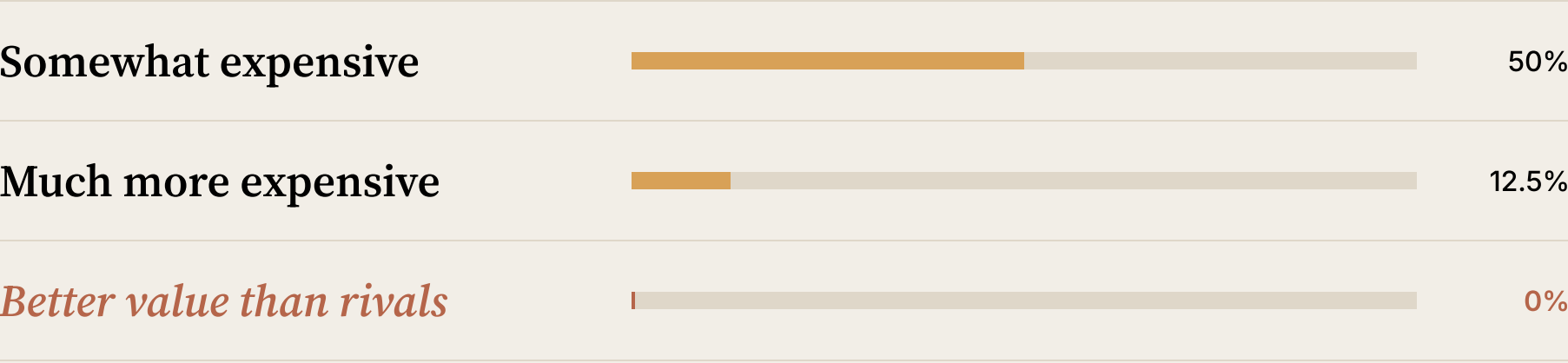
Among the minority who know the brand, Sonos is more often a backup than a first pick. The awareness gap is the single most important matter the audit surfaced.

SECTION 04 — PRIMARY RESEARCH / PRICE

Premium, read as penalty.

Premium pricing only works when the audience can name what the premium buys. Right now they can't: most see the price, and not one respondent saw better value behind it.

HOW RESPONDENTS PERCEIVE SONOS PRICING

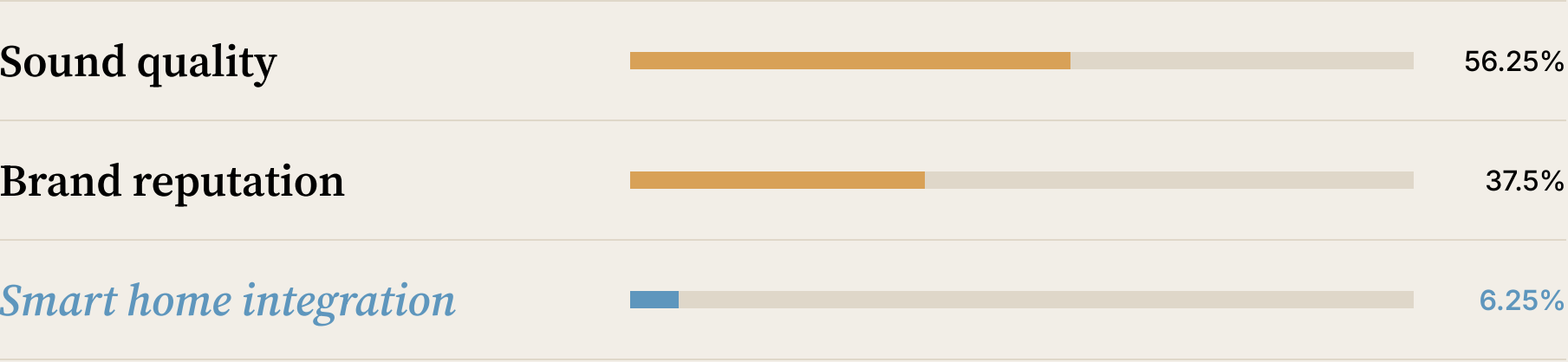


SECTION 04 — PRIMARY RESEARCH / DRIVERS

People buy the sound.

Sound quality decides a majority of purchases and reputation carries another third. Smart home integration, the feature Sonos leads with, moves about one buyer in sixteen. And 81% said they would pick Apple or Bose first.

WHAT DRIVES THE PURCHASE DECISION



The product converts. *The brand doesn't reach.*

41% of registrations come from repeat buyers. The people who hear Sonos buy it again.
The problem is the 62.5% who have never heard the name.

RECOMMENDATION 01

Integrate with culture. Authentically.

The lifestyle positioning is aspirational; the cultural relevance hasn't caught up, especially with women and younger buyers. IKEA and Liverpool FC are a start, not a connection to the design-conscious 25-to-30 crowd Sonos wants.

01 — LIFESTYLE VOICES

Design and mindful-living creators who skew female. Women in tech and music production showing the craft.

02 — FASHION COLLABORATIONS

Limited editions with Acne Studios, Kith, or Stone Island. Pop-up retail with fashion partners.

03 — MUSIC INTEGRATION

Sound-focused artists and female producers and DJs, with content built from their production process.

04 — EXPERIENCES

Immersive retail and curated events at the intersection of fashion, music, and design.

RECOMMENDATION 02

Make the premium make sense.

62.5% of respondents call Sonos expensive, and the 41% repeat-purchase rate proves the quality case lands once people hear it. The job is closing the distance between the price tag and the proof.

01 — "HEAR THE DIFFERENCE"

A campaign built on blind listening tests against competitors, staged in public and on camera.

02 — DEMONSTRATIONS

Showcases of sound quality and innovation, with artists and producers explaining the engineering.

03 — PROOF OF PREMIUM

Patented innovations, pro audio endorsements, and technical benchmarking made public.

04 — INVESTMENT FRAMING

Position the price as an investment in quality of life, backed by long-term owner testimonials.

RECOMMENDATION 03

Optimize the distribution.

Retail partners bring in 85% of revenue, but direct-to-consumer carries the margins and the customer relationships. The buying experience has to improve everywhere people actually shop.

01 — EXPERIENCE ROOMS

Take the curated listening-room concept beyond Best Buy to other high-end retailers.

02 — DIGITAL RETAIL

Reimagine the online store around interactive demos instead of spec sheets.

03 — CERTIFIED INSTALLERS

Build a network of certified installers for premium whole-home setups.

04 — THE DTC BALANCE

Grow the direct channel without starving the retail partnerships that pay the bills.

THANK YOU

The sound was never the
problem.
Being heard is.

Culture first, then proof, then distribution. Executed in that order, Sonos competes with Bose and holds the line against the giants.